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Mega Menu Manager

User Guide & Visual Reference

This guide explains how to use the **B&H Mega Menu Manager** — an internal admin tool for visualizing and configuring the navigation structure displayed across B&H's category-browsing experience.

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1 TOOL OVERVIEW

What is the Mega Menu Manager?

The **B&H Mega Menu Manager** (bh-mega-menu.html) is an internal admin tool that lets you visualize and configure the drop-down navigation menus customers see when browsing bhphotovideo.com. It provides a live preview of the three-column mega menu alongside a built-in admin panel for managing which categories and links appear — and in what order — within each department.

The tool consists of three interconnected pages:

- **bh-mega-menu.html** — Live preview + Admin panel (this guide)
- **category-detail.html** — Deep per-category slot editor
- **data-management.html** — Master list of departments and labels

■ All three pages share data through your browser's localStorage. Changes made in any one page are immediately visible in the others — no server required.

2 THE NAVIGATION BAR

15 Top-Level Departments

The green navigation bar running across the top of the page contains **15 department tabs**. Hovering any tab opens that department's mega menu. Two tabs have special visual treatment:

- **Used** — displays in yellow text to draw attention to refurbished inventory.
- **Specials** — also yellow, highlighting promotional content.

Department	CatID	What it covers
Photography	989	Digital cameras, lenses, tripods, accessories, darkroom
Computers	9581	Laptops, desktops, tablets, monitors, peripherals
Pro Video	3755	Cinema cameras, camcorders, recorders, post-production
Lighting	1161	LED, tungsten, HMI, strobe, modifiers, stands
Pro Audio	12154	Microphones, mixers, monitors, recorders, live sound
Drones	27989	Consumer, prosumer, FPV, enterprise, accessories
Camcorders	1820	Consumer & professional camcorders, action cameras
TVs & Entertainment	4600	Televisions, projectors, home audio, streaming
Audio-Visual	3644	Presentation, conferencing, AV cables, mounts

Department	CatID	What it covers
Optics	978	Binoculars, telescopes, night vision, rangefinders
Mobile	8565	Smartphones, tablets, gimbals, mobile accessories
Surveillance	3496	Security cameras, NVRs, access control, alarms
More	47088	Musical instruments, home & garden, sports, auto
Used	2870	Used photography, video, computers, audio, TVs
Specials	—	Deal zone, weekly specials, clearance, open box

Table 1 — All 15 navigation departments and their CatIDs.

3 MEGA MENU STRUCTURE

Four-Column Layout

When a department tab is hovered, a four-column drop-down panel appears beneath the navigation bar. Understanding each column's role is key to configuring the menu effectively.

Col 1 — Categories	Col 2 — Sub-categories	Col 3 — Tertiary	Col 4 — Contextual
★ Featured items (Slots 1–5, green badge)	Appears when you hover a Category item	Appears when Sub-category has children	Static links:
Regular categories (Slots 6–30)	e.g. DSLRs, Mirrorless, Medium Format...	e.g. Solid State Recorder Accessories sub-items	• Specials in Category • Used Items • New Arrivals • Buying Guide • Talk to an Expert

Table 2 — Four-column mega menu layout.

Column 1 — Categories

The leftmost column lists all items configured for the selected department. **Slots 1–5** (the featured slots) appear at the very top, prefixed with a green ★ star badge. **Slots 6–30** follow immediately below as regular category links. Hovering any item that has children causes Column 2 to appear.

Column 2 — Sub-categories

Populated automatically when you hover a Category item that has child entries defined in the MENUS data (e.g. hovering "Digital Cameras" shows DSLRs, Mirrorless, Medium Format, Point & Shoot, Film Cameras). Items with further children trigger Column 3.

Column 3 — Tertiary

A third level, activated only when a sub-category itself has children. This is used for deeply nested categories such as *Recorders & Duplication* → *Solid State Recorder Accessories* within Pro Video.

Column 4 — Contextual Links

A fixed right-hand column that appears alongside every open mega menu. It contains category-agnostic navigation shortcuts: *Specials in Category*, *Used Items*, *New Arrivals*, a *Buying Guide* link, and a prominent *Talk to an Expert* call-to-action.

- Clicking the dark backdrop area outside the mega menu — or hovering away from the nav bar — closes the menu automatically.

4 THE FEATURED SLOTS SYSTEM

30 Slots per Department

Each of the 15 departments has **30 configurable slots**. The slots are divided into two tiers:

Slots 1–5 ★ FEATURED

Slots 6–30 REGULAR CATEGORIES

Featured Slots (1–5)

Featured slots are your prime real estate. Items assigned to slots 1–5 appear at the **very top of Column 1** in the mega menu, each decorated with a green ★ star badge and a light green row background. Use these for the most important or high-traffic sub-categories within a department.

Regular Category Slots (6–30)

Slots 6 through 30 display in standard style beneath the featured items. Null (empty) slots are skipped — the menu renders only the slots that contain an assigned item, so leaving slots empty is harmless.

- A department with no slots configured will render an empty Column 1. Always verify by hovering the department tab in the preview after making changes.

5 USING THE ADMIN PANEL

The Mega Menu Manager Panel

The **Admin Panel** is a collapsible dark-green bar fixed to the bottom of the page. It has two main areas: a **search row** for selecting a department, and a **two-pane editor** that shows its slot list alongside an inline editor form.

Collapsing and Expanding

Click the ▼ / ▲ button on the far right of the dark-green topbar to collapse or expand the Admin Panel. This is useful when you want to see the full-page mega menu preview without the panel in the way.

Step 1 — Load a Department

- 1 Click inside the **Category ID** input box at the top of the panel. A typeahead dropdown appears as you type — you can search by **numeric CatID** or by **department name**.
- 2 Select a suggestion from the dropdown, or type the exact CatID and press Enter.
- 3 Click the **Load** → button. The two-pane editor appears, showing all 30 slots for that department.

Step 2 — Review the Slot List (Left Pane)

The left pane shows all 30 slots in a scrollable list. Each row displays:

- A **slot number** (1–30).
- A **label** showing the item name, or *empty* in italic if the slot has nothing assigned.
- A **type badge** (LABEL, CATID, or URL) in grey.
- A **X remove button** on the right to clear the slot.
- A **■ drag handle** on the left for reordering.

Slots 1–5 are separated from slots 6–30 by a section divider labelled "★ Featured (1–5) · Categories (6–30)".

Step 3 — Edit a Slot (Right Pane)

- 1 Click any slot row in the left pane. The right pane switches from the empty-state prompt to the **editor form**, titled "Slot N" with the current assignment as a subtitle.
- 2 Choose a **Type** from the dropdown: *Label*, *CatID*, or *Custom URL*. The relevant input fields appear immediately.
- 3 Fill in the type-specific fields (see Section 6 for details on each type).
- 4 Click **Save to Slot**. The slot list on the left updates instantly and the mega menu preview reflects the change.
- 5 Click **Cancel** at any time to discard changes to the current slot without saving.

■ The **Save to Slot** button is disabled until you select a **Type** and provide the required fields. It will re-enable as soon as the form is valid.

Clearing a Slot

To remove an item from a slot without replacing it, click the **X** button on the right side of that slot row in the left pane. The slot reverts to empty immediately.

6 SLOT TYPES REFERENCE

Three Ways to Fill a Slot

When editing a slot, you must first choose a **Type**. Each type produces a different kind of link in the mega menu.

Type	What it does	When to use
Label	Picks a named sub-section heading from the category's predefined label list (e.g. "Cameras & Lenses").	For standard section headers that already exist in the label library.
CatID	Links directly to a B&H catalog category by its numeric ID (e.g. 9811 for Digital Cameras).	For specific product category pages. Use the typeahead search to find the right ID.
Custom URL	Points to any URL you specify, with a custom display label in the menu.	For promotions, landing pages, or links that don't have a standard CatID.

Table 3 — Slot type comparison.

Type: Label

Selecting *Label* reveals a scrollable list of predefined sub-section headings for the loaded department. These labels come from the **Data Management** page and represent the blue section headers visible in the mega menu (e.g. "Cameras & Lenses", "Accessories"). Click a label to select it; a green ✓ checkmark confirms your selection.

Type: CatID

Selecting *CatID* reveals a typeahead search field. Type a numeric ID or partial category name to search the known child-category database (over 150 entries). When the correct category appears in the dropdown, click it to populate the field. A result panel below confirms the category name once a valid ID is found.

■ If you know the exact CatID, you can type it directly and press the **Search** button to validate it without using the typeahead.

Type: Custom URL

Selecting *Custom URL* reveals two fields:

- **Custom URL** — the full destination URL (e.g. <https://www.bhphotovideo.com/...>). Must begin with <https://>.
- **Label** — the display text that appears in the mega menu for this link.

7 DRAG-AND-DROP REORDERING

Reordering Slots Without Typing

You can change the order of items in the slot list by dragging rows up or down. This is the fastest way to promote an item to a featured slot or change the relative ordering within the regular category section.

- 1 Hover over a slot row in the left pane. A ■ **drag handle** appears on the far left of the row.
- 2 Click and hold the drag handle, then drag the row to its new position.
- 3 An **orange indicator line** shows where the row will land when you release.
- 4 Release to drop. The slot list reorders immediately and the mega menu preview updates.

■ Dragging a populated row into slots 1–5 makes it featured; dragging it below slot 5 removes its featured status. The ★ badge updates automatically.

8 DATA & STORAGE

How Changes Are Persisted

The Mega Menu Manager does not connect to a backend server. All data is stored in your **browser's localStorage** and is therefore specific to the browser and device you are using.

localStorage key	What it stores
bh_featured	All 30 slot assignments for every department. Written on every Save to Slot action.
bh_dm_state	Navigation category names, CatIDs, and child labels. Written from Data Management.
bh_last_catId	The CatID last viewed in Category Detail, used to pre-fill the detail page link.

Table 4 — localStorage keys used by the tool suite.

■ Clearing your browser's site data or browsing history will erase all slot configurations. Export to Excel from the Data Management page before doing so.

Resetting to Default Data

To wipe all configurations and restore factory defaults, open your browser's DevTools Console (F12 on Windows, ■+Option+J on Mac) and run:

```
localStorage.removeItem('bh_featured'); localStorage.removeItem('bh_dm_state');
```

Then refresh the page.

9 NAVIGATING BETWEEN TOOLS

Quick Links Within the Admin Panel

The dark-green topbar of the Admin Panel contains links to the two companion tools:

- **Data Management** ■ — opens data-management.html where you can add, edit, or remove top-level departments and child category labels.
- **Open Category Detail** ■ — opens category-detail.html in a new tab for deep per-category slot editing (featured banners, promo images, etc.).

■ The Category Detail link automatically points to the last CatID you worked with, so you can jump straight back to the right department.

10 QUICK-REFERENCE SUMMARY

Common Tasks at a Glance

Task	How
Preview a department's mega menu	Hover the department tab in the green nav bar.
Open the Admin Panel	It is always visible at the bottom of the page. Click ▲ to expand if collapsed.
Load a department's slots	Type its name or CatID in the search box → click Load →.
Assign an item to a slot	Click the slot row → choose Type → fill fields → Save to Slot.
Make an item featured (★)	Assign it to any of slots 1–5, or drag it up into the featured zone.
Remove featured status	Drag the item below slot 5, or clear the slot with X and reassign it lower.
Reorder items	Drag the ■ handle on any slot row to a new position.
Clear a slot	Click the X button on the slot row.
Add / rename a department	Go to Data Management → Navigation Categories section.
Add / edit child labels	Go to Data Management → Child Category Labels section.
Export all data to Excel	Go to Data Management → click ■ Export Excel.
Reset everything to defaults	DevTools Console: <code>localStorage.removeItem('bh_featured')</code> then refresh.

■ For a visual walkthrough, open [bh-mega-menu.html](#) in your browser and hover each department tab while referring to Section 3 of this guide.